

Wanna be an Open Source lakhpati?

The Red Hat Indian Open has just been declared open, and the prize money is Rs 10 lakh. Jointly sponsored by Open Source leader Red Hat, and IIT Bombay's Kanwal Rekhi School of Information Technology (KReSIT), April marks the start of the Red Hat scholarship programme.

Evangelised by KReSIT's Prof. Deepak Phatak, the scholarship will try to attract the programming prowess of engineering students across India. The Indian Institute of Information Technology Bangalore's Prof S Sadagopan is also involved in it.

If you want to win Rs 10 lakh, you will have to create "world-class" applications in Open Source that will benefit the team at large. These will be judged by a team of experts from KReSIT, IIT Bombay. Red Hat and Prof Phatak, meanwhile, say that all the code submitted would have to be covered by the GPL, LGPL or BSD licenses.

Red Hat India will then fund the winning team to the tune of Rs 10 lakh. A team of mentors from the software industry will guide the students, and the participants will be offered internships at Red Hat.

snapshot

One in six US Internet users have logged on using **Wi-Fi** or another **wireless technology**

Source: www.washingtonpost.com

How small can you get?

Open your eyes wide. Really wide. OK, now we will first give the background..*kkrieger* is a first person shooter game, complete with all the effects you'd expect.

There are guns, monsters with detail, different levels, the works. When you fire at the monsters, the weapons light up your enemies to reveal more details. There are shadows, and your ammunition even bounces off floors.

Now comes the time to pop your eyes out as you read this: the size of the game is 96 KB. Not 96 MB, 96 KB!

Surely, then, there is a catch? Yes, you got that right.

There are two, in fact.

Firstly, the beta version crashes, there are clipping and collision problems. Second—and listen closely—you need the at least the following: 512 MB of RAM, a 1.5 GHz Pentium 3 or Athlon, a Geforce4Ti or ATI Radeon8500 graphics card supporting pixel shaders 1.3, preferably with 128 MB of VRAM and DirectX 9.0b.

So what do you think? How come a 96 KB game shows all these effects, and why is it so demanding on system resources? If you can figure out how exactly *kkrieger* does it, write in to smallgame@thinkdigit.com.

tomorrow's technology

Beyond Silicon: Plastic

Xerox, the company whose research labs gave us the computer mouse, is now working on the future of silicon-based transistors—and their vision of the future isn't silicon, but plastics.

US-based TDA research has come up with something similar—they're looking at conductive polymers. Both systems work with technology that has, up until now, seemed impractical, but have come up with workable solutions that could be used in, say, low-quality displays.

The Xerox project works using a molecule that can be used as a semiconductor, and remains stable under normal conditions. Once printed into place, the molecules can orient themselves into the bigger structure. Xerox has also developed two other molecules: one that acts as a metal-like conductor, and another that acts as a dielec-

tric. These form the basic parts of semiconductors, and can be used to make printable chips.

Xerox's PARC been working on an electronic array that can be used as the back-pane for a display, and the plastic semi-conductors could be integrated for low-performance displays.

TDA's solution works on a polymer called Pedot. Pedot can act as a conductor, but gets corrupted by water. TDA re-engineered this by adding two more molecules, and calls this Oligotron. TDA also created a solvent bath that lets users work with the material. The resultant material could be used to make soda bottles that talk straight to inventory management devices.

It's a big market for non-silicon low-cost solutions, and both Xerox and TDA are working towards getting their plastics and polymers to edge out silicon.

quoteworthy

"Despite assertions made by Linux vendors, a Linux cluster is not a high performance computer. At best, clusters are a loose collection of unmanaged, individual, microprocessor-based computers"

Dr Paul Terry, CTO, Cray Canada, at the ClusterWorld Conference & Expo 2004, at San Jose, California, USA.

"...That was just poor wording on our part...stuff that's on tapes, and those are offline – we'd eventually delete it, but we can't guarantee an instantaneous deletion."

Google co-founder Sergey Brin in eWeek, referring to fears about Gmail, Google's 1000 MB free email service, where deleted emails would remain archived on servers.

"I doubt you'd see them settle any frivolous lawsuits, but it looks inevitable that there will be more suits based on the position of Windows in the market"

Richard Donovan, chairman, Antitrust unit, Kelley Drye & Warren, a US law firm. Microsoft had agreed to a presettlement in an antitrust suit regarding overcharging for for Windows and Office